Zoe Unica Solaris

Seattle, WA | 206-532-7742 | z@zusolaris.space | linkedin.com/in/zusolaris | zusolaris.space

EDUCATION

University of Washington | Seattle, WA

BDes in Interaction Design, Minor in Business | Expected June 2028

- North Seattle College | *AA* | GPA: 3.51 | June 2026
- Code Fellows | *Certificate, Full-Stack JS Development* | Feb 2023

FEATURED UX CASE STUDY

HUSK-E | Handheld Pro-Social Companion System | *Lead Designer & Prototyper*

- Architected end-to-end user flows, companion state engine, and hardware settings in Figma/FigJam.
- Engineered a low-cost (<$20) tangible prototype using ESP32-S3, NFC, and haptics for physical-digital interaction.
- Modeled ergonomic enclosures in Fusion 360 and developed interactive multi-state visual assets in Spline.

EXPERIENCE

North Seattle College | *Student Body Vice President* | June 2025 – June 2026 | Seattle, WA

- Led institutional research for 5,000+ students, translating feedback into tech access and equitable resource initiatives.
- Spearheaded governance restructuring, including drafting and passing the college's first institutional AI Use Policy.
- Partnered with executive administration to improve service delivery for underrepresented student groups.

University of Washington | *Undergraduate Researcher* | June 2024 – August 2024 | Seattle, WA

- Evaluated micro-scale material patterns (h-BN, Graphene, $MoTe_2$) to optimize thermal efficiency in computing substrates.
- Built an image-analysis pipeline in GNU Octave, converting microscope imagery to spatial data at 0.67 nm/pixel.
- Presented findings at SACNAS; awarded Best Research in Engineering at PNW LSAMP.

STEMTAC Foundation | *Design & Prototyping Intern* | Jan 2024 – June 2024 | Bellevue, WA

- Designed modular 3D-printable housing components in Fusion 360 and Autodesk Inventor.
- Applied computer vision tools (OpenFace, Roboflow) to analyze user interaction data and inform spatial ergonomics.
- Coordinated multi-disciplinary sessions to align fabrication constraints with community-centered design.

United States Navy | *Information Systems Technician (Submarines), ITS2* | Jan 2019 – June 2022 | Silverdale, WA

- Managed human-system interfaces, virtualization, and network architecture across 4 high-security environments.
- Optimized operator workflows and system troubleshooting protocols to minimize cognitive load under constraint.
- Maintained 99.9% uptime for critical multi-platform infrastructure across air-gapped Linux and Windows systems.

SKILLS & TOOLS

- Design & Prototyping: Figma, FigJam, Spline, Adobe Illustrator/Photoshop, Fusion 360, Godot, Hardware Prototyping, 3D Printing
- UX & Research: Journey Mapping, Wireframing, Usability Testing, Systems Thinking, Information Architecture, Heuristic Evaluation
- Technical: HTML5, CSS3, JavaScript (ES6+), Python, React, Git/GitHub, Linux/Unix

HONORS & LEADERSHIP

- Best Research in Engineering | PNW LSAMP Conference, Oregon State University (2025)
- WA NASA Space Grant Consortium Scholar | North Seattle College (2025)
- Terrific Tree Frog Student Leadership Service Award | North Seattle College (2026)
- Submarine Warfare & Deep Submergence Insignias | United States Navy (2021, 2022)
- Founder & President | SEDS, NSC Chapter (2024–2025)
- Co-Leader | Queer Trans-Cooperative, North Seattle College (2025–2026)